NewsBank
Plain Dealer (published as THE PLAIN DEALER) - March 21, 2004 - page 48
March 21, 2004 | Plain Dealer (published as THE PLAIN DEALER) | Cleveland, Ohio | Page 48

DIVISION III

Royals can't get on board for trip to state

JACK MCDERMOTT
Plain Dealer Reporter

BOWLING GREEN, OHIO — Cuyahoga Valley Christian Academy's hopes of a state final four appearance were "boarded up" Saturday night.

The Royals dropped a 53-36 decision to St. Henry in a Division III regional championship game in Anderson Arena at Bowling Green State University.

The Redskins (20-5) wasted little time in gaining control, opening a 13-8 first quarter lead, then expanding it to 27-16 by the half. Steve Sutter, a 6-6 junior, was the force behind St. Henry's opening surge, scoring seven points, then finishing the contest with a game-high 19 points.

Sutter scored only five points Thursday night when the Redskins defeated Clear Fork, 51-41, in a regional semifinal. Sutter played only 16 minutes because of foul trouble.

ST. HENRY	53
CVCA	36

Saturday night was a different story, as he was whistled for just one foul while connecting on 5-of-6 free throws for the game.

However, the big difference against the Royals (21-4) came in the rebounding department, with St. Henry pulling down 43 to CVCA's 29. Sutter's 6-9 sophomore teammate, Kurt Huelsman, controlled that department, grabbing 16 boards and scoring 12 points.

"We've only been outrebounded in two contests this season coming into tonight," said CVCA first-year coach Jay Peters. "That definitely played a major role in deciding the outcome. They're big, physical kids and I was very impressed with them."

Meanwhile, the Royals' big man, 6-8 junior Ted Lawver, was in foul trouble for most of the contest. He picked up his second early in the second quarter and his third just 1:25 into the second half, forcing him to sit for the rest of the third period. Lawver picked up his fourth and fifth of the night in a 20-second span, fouling out with 4:53 remaining in the game.

Just seconds before, CVCA had cut a 37-26 deficit to 39-33 with 5:28 remaining in the game thanks to a 15-footer by 6-3 sophomore Tim Carroll. Lawver fouled out with six points and three rebounds in 21 minutes.

"We came out tonight with an aggressive attitude and things just went our way," said St. Henry coach Joe Niekamp. "We've got a lot of balance on our team, and it seems like every time out someone else is stepping up to get the job done. Tonight it was Sutter's shooting and Huelsman's rebounding that kept us going."

St. Henry's board domination allowed the Redskins to get 26 points in the paint to the Royals' 12. St. Henry also scored 20 points off turnovers while the Royals managed eight.

Jon Bierman led CVCA scorers with 11 points.

"We knew [Bierman] was their scoring leader and we kept a hand in his face for most of the night," Niekamp said. "And we had Sutter keeping an eye on [Andrew] Wides. Wides was their scoring leader the other night and Steve held him to just three points tonight."

Peters felt the Royals got caught up in the tempo early on.

"Our decision-making wasn't what it should have been, and by the start of the second half we'd made some adjustments. But, it was too little, too late."

State semifinals
THURSDAY
Loudonville (22-2) vs St. Henry (20-5), 11 a.m.
Bellaire (22-4) vs. Versailles (26-0), 2

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DIVISION I



PHIL LONG | SPECIAL TO THE PLAIN DEALER

Bulldogs players go through the agony of watching St. John's accept the trophy for winning the Division I regional title at Toledo after Olmsted Falls lost to the Titans.

Reason for loss is hard to miss

MIKE PETICCA
Plain Dealer Reporter

TOLEDO — Sometimes, there's little a basketball team can do other than hope.

Olmsted Falls was faced with that dilemma Saturday night in front of 6,700 fans in Savage Hall. The Bulldogs hoped against hope that Toledo St. John's would begin to miss its shots. It never happened.

"I thought we did a decent job on defense. We had hands in their faces," Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue said after St. John's shot a remarkable 75 percent and defeated the Bulldogs, 79-62, in a Division I regional championship game.

"It's hard to beat a team that is going to shoot 80 percent, and they almost did that."

TOLEDO ST. JOHN'S	79
OLMSTED FALLS	62

The Titans' shooting advanced them to a state semifinal game against Columbus Brookhaven on Friday night in Columbus. St. John's, a two-time state runner-up and a state semifinalist last year, is 21-5, including an 11-1 record in Savage Hall.

St. John's made 15 of 16 shots in the second half. Its only miss was on a forced shot near the end of the third quarter.

"I don't remember the one they missed," Donahue said.

"The confidence level was very high after we made a couple of shots," Titans junior forward B.J. Raymond said. "You could just see the shots going in in your head."

Olmsted Falls senior guards Steve Gansey, Dan Binggeli and Jamar Scales closed their prep careers with solid efforts. Gansey and Binggeli scored 16 and 14 points, respectively, and Scales tallied 11. Junior forward Pat Braddick scored 10 points for the Bulldogs (22-3).

"We set a goal at the beginning of the year to make the final four," Gansey said. "We just came up short. I'm proud of the players and coaches. Toledo St. John's is a great team."

St. John's boasts at least three players who are considered certain Division I college players, and they combined for 63 points on 26-of-34 shooting. The 6-6 Raymond and senior point guard Brian Roberts both scored 25. Roberts was 10-of-15 from the field and Raymond was 11-of-14. They were a combined 5-of-6 on 3-point shots. Zach Hillesland, a 6-7 junior forward, scored 13 points.

Yet it took the Titans more than three quarters to dispatch the valiant Bulldogs. Gansey's four-point play, Braddick's 3-pointer and two layups by senior forward Corey Sparks helped Olmsted Falls reduce a 52-37 St. John's lead to 56-50 going into the fourth quarter.

A missed Titans' shot or two might have extended the Bulldogs' rally. Instead, St. John's made all eight of its fourth quarter shots and used a 15-2 run to build its lead to 71-52. Raymond began the surge with a 3-pointer and Hillesland followed that with a three-point play.

Olmsted Falls mixed up its defenses in a vain effort to slow the Titans. St. John's defeated Rhodes, 60-47, in Thursday night's semifinal game, but had difficulty against the Rams' full-court press. Saturday, St. John's was usually able to handle Olmsted Falls' pressure defense.

"You get frustrated for the kids," Donahue said. "We were trying a lot of things. We were grasping for straws. Once a team starts to shoot like they were, it gets into a rhythm."

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GIRLS STATE ROUNDUP

Ursuline rolls to Div. III crown

From wire reports

Courtney Davidson scored 21 points and got her teammates easy baskets with a deft array of passes, sending Youngstown Ursuline to the Division III state girls basketball championship with a 66-52 win over Oak Hill on Saturday in Columbus.

Davidson, the division's co-player of the year, had eight assists, many of them on no-look and behind-the-back passes that led to layups. She was particularly sharp in the third quarter, when the Fighting Irish (26-2) outscored the Oaks, 24-12, to take a 51-43 lead.

Whitney Hale scored 22 points and Alyssa Hammond, who shared Player of the Year honors with Davidson, added 18 for the Oaks (25-2), the first team from Jackson County to reach a state basketball tournament.

Cin. Mt. Notre Dame 59, Dayton Chaminade-Julienne 44 With Ms. Basketball Mel Thomas leading the way with both scoring and passing, Cincinnati Mount Notre Dame won the Division I state title.

The battle of unbeatens was a mismatch early and late. The Cougars (28-0) built their lead to double figures at the end of the first quarter and led by 14 at halftime.

Beloit West Branch 42, Hamilton Badin 39 Tori Arndt had 18 points and 14 rebounds to lead West Branch to a physical Division II championship.

The Warriors (26-1) and Rams (22-6) pushed and shoved on every possession, a big reason why the teams shot a combined 23-for-71 from the field. West Branch only hit 13 of 35 shots from the field and Badin finished 10-for-36, but an offensive show wasn't expected.

Minster 44, Mansfield St. Peter's 33 Minster converted turnovers to points in the key third-quarter run that carried the Wildcats to the Division IV state championship.

Robyn Hoying, who started the run with a steal, led the Wildcats (25-2) with 16 points and nine rebounds. She also made 8 of 8 free throws and earned MVP honors of the all-tournament team.

HIGH SCHOOL SCOREBOARD

Boys Basketball
Regional Finals
Division I
UNIV. OF AKRON

Canton McKinley	20	19	14	13	66
Collinwood	17	14	11	15	57

Canton McKinley (22-3): Parker 4-2-12, Hall 10-2-22, Daily 2-0-4, Weatherspoon 2-0-5, Morgan 7-4-18, Broyles 0-2-2, Brown 1-0-2
Collinwood (21-4): Sorrell 5-0-11, Faulker 4-0-9, Weaver 5-4-14, Simon 4-0-8, Mitchell 0-4-4, Campbell 4-3-11
UNIV. OF TOLEDO

Olmsted Falls	12	15	23	12	62
Tol. St. Johns	20	18	18	23	79

Olmsted Falls (22-3): Binggeli 4-5-14, Braddick 4-0-10, Scales 5-0-11, Gansey 5-3-16, Mental 2-0-5, Sanfilippo 1-0-2, Sparks 2-0-4
Tol. St. Johns (22-4): Keller 4-1-9, Heintschel 1-0-2, Roberts 10-3-25, Hillesland 5-3-13, Raymond 11-0-25, Floyd 1-0-2, Cassidy 1-0-2, Schoen 0-1-1.
COLUMBUS FAIRGROUNDS
Cols. Brookhaven 52, Cin. Moeller 48.
UNIVERISITY OF DAYTON
Hamilton 54, Spring. S. 45
Division II
CANTON CIVIC CENTER

West Geauga	2	10	13	17	42
Canal Fulton	8	10	12	21	52

West Geauga (22-3): Picciano 3-3-10, Lubelski 2-0-4, Reinhard 2-2-8, Fairfield 1-0-2, Latourette 3-0-6, Skuski 3-1-7, DiFranco 2-0-5
Canal Fulton (24-1): Haslar 2-2-6, Balrea 1-2-5, Eavns 1-0-2, Lewis 3-5-12, Moore 1-0-2, Sette 2-7-11, Samsa 6-1-13.
UNIV. OF TOLEDO

Ottawa-Glandorf	12	16	12	14	54
SVSM	6	21	18	7	52

Ottawa-Glandorf (25-1): Hermiller 2-0-5, E. Pollitz 8-4-20, Furtman 2-0-4, T. Pollitz 9-3-21, Fought 1-2-4
St. Vincent-St. Mary (20-5): Weems 3-0-7, Jones 3-0-8, Johnson 4-2-10, Sims 4-0-8, Wilson 6-4-16, Nygaard 1-0-3.
WRIGHT ST. UNIV.
Day. Chaminade-Julienne 46, Cols. Watterson 44
OHIO UNIVERSITY
Dover 57, Beechcroft 54

Division III
BOWLING GREEN ST. UNIV.

CVCA	8	8	10	10	36
St. Henry	13	14	10	16	53

Cuyahoga Christian Valley Academy (21-4): Ti. Carroll 3-0-6, Wides 1-0-3, Lawver 2-2-6, Diakandru 1-0-3, Bierman 5-1-11, T.J. Carroll 2-0-4, Workman 1-0-2, Fairfax 0-1-1
St. Henry (20-5): Schwieterman 1-0-3, Sutter 7-5-19, Huelsman 4-4-12, Post 1-1-3, Stahl 1-1-3, Niekamp 4-2-11, Puthoff 1-0-2
CANTON FIELDHOUSE

St. Thomas Aquinas	6	13	5	13	37
Loudonville	13	8	14	19	54

St. Thomas Aquinas (22-3): Singletary 1-0-2, Balcarcell 3-0-9, Schott 4-1-10, Jackson 2-0-4, Zappitelli 1-3-5, Underwood 2-0-4
Loudonville (23-2): Spreng 4-2-11, Huffman 2-3-8, Young 5-4-16, Humphrey 4-0-8, Scott 1-4-6, Stitzlein 1-0-3, Gillette 1-0-2
OHIO UNIVERSITY
Bellaire 71, Chesapeake 68
WRIGHT ST.
Versailles 58, Reading 50

GIRLS BASKETBALL
State Finals
Division I

Mt. Notre Dame	19	5	18	17	59
Chaminade-Julienne	8	2	16	18	44

Cincinnati Mt. Notre Dame (28-0):Stephens 5-9 6-6 20, Shipley 1-4 0-0 2, Thomas 7-12 2-3 21, Brannen 1-2 0-0 2, Jones 3-6 0-3 6, Rohlfs 0-2 4-4 4, Estes 2-2 0-1 4, Mills 0-0 0-0 0, Bobinski 0-3 0-0 0. Totals 19-40 12-17 59.
Day. Chaminade-Julienne (26-1): Getty 2-15 7-8 11, Jefferson 9-14 2-3 21, Busch 2-7 0-0 4, Schafer 1-3 0-0 3, Goldsberry 1-2 0-2 3, Heildoerfer 0-0 0-0 0, Williams 1-2 0-0 2. Totals 16-43 9-13 44.
3-Point Goals—Mt. Notre Dame 9-19 (Thomas 5-8, Stephens 4-7, Rohlfs 0-1, Bobinski 0-1, Shipley 0-2), Chaminade-Julienne 3-11 (Jefferson 1-1, Goldsberry 1-2, Schafer 1-3, Busch 0-1, Getty 0-4). Fouled out—Jefferson. Rebounds—Mt. Notre Dame 28 (Stephens, Jones 7), Chaminade-Julienne 24 (Busch 8). Assists—Mt. Notre Dame 15 (Thomas 5), Chaminade-Julienne 8 (Getty, Busch 3). Total fouls—Mt. Notre Dame 14, Chaminade-Julienne 19. A—5,301.
Division II

Hamilton Badin	8	6	7	18	39
West Branch	11	9	4	18	42

Hamilton Badin (22-6): Beckett 1-8 2-3 4, Pfirman 2-2 0-1 5, Horvath 2-7 11-12 15, Riegert 2-5 3-4 7, Fiehrer 3-11 0-0 6, Jackson 0-1 2-2 2, Young 0-1 0-0 0, McCoy 0-1 0-2 0. Totals 10-36 18-24 39.
Beloit West Branch (26-1): Geiger 1-5 0-0 3, Woods 1-5 2-2 4, Armstrong 2-7 7-10 12, Arndt 8-15 2-5 18, Braden 1-1 2-4 5, Bryte 0-1 0-0 0, Morgan 0-1 0-0 0. Totals 13-35 13-21 42.
3-Point Goals—Badin 1-7 (Pfirman 1-1, Fiehrer 0-2, Beckett 0-4), W. Branch 3-7 (Braden 1-1, Armstrong 1-2, Geiger 1-3, Bryte 0-1). Fouled out—Fiehrer, Woods. Rebounds—Badin 25 (Horvath 10), W. Branch 30 (Arndt 14). Assists—Badin 7 (Beckett, Pfirman, Fiehrer 2), W. Branch 12 (Geiger, Woods, Armstrong 3). Total fouls—Badin 19, W. Branch 20. A—6,204.
Division III

Oak Hill	16	15	12	9	52
Ursuline	14	13	24	15	66

Oak Hill (25-2): Slone 0-2 0-0 0, Midkiff 2-2 0-0 4, Davis 1-6 2-2 5, Hammond 7-16 3-3 18, Hale 11-13 0-0 22, Moore 0-0 0-0 0, McGoon 1-4 0-0 3, Ruff 0-0 0-0 0. Totals 22-43 5-5 52.
Youngstown Ursuline (26-2): Dickson 3-7 2-3 8, Davidson 8-19 2-2 21, Grant 9-17 4-8 22, Slattery 4-5 0-0 9, Bennett 2-5 0-0 4, Miller 1-1 0-1 2, Klempay 0-0 0-0 0. Totals 27-54 9-14 66.
3-Point Goals—Oak Hill 3-13 (Davis 1-3, Hammond 1-4, McGoon 1-4, Slone 0-2), Ursuline 4-11 (Davidson 3-10, Slattery 1-1). Fouled out—Midkiff. Rebounds—Oak Hill 26 (Hale 8), Ursuline 28 (Grant 9). Assists—Oak Hill 14 (Hammond 5), Ursuline 16 (Davidson 8). Total fouls—Oak Hill 17, Ursuline 8. A—6,044.
Division IV

Minster	10	12	9	13	44
St. Peter's	6	9	4	14	33

Minster (25-2): Shenk 1-5 4-6 6, Brackman 3-9 0-3 7, Slonkosky 2-2 0-2 5, Bornhorst 1-2 0-1 2, Hoying 4-11 8-8 16, Westerheide 0-0 0-0 0, Morsey 0-0 0-0 0, Olding 1-2 3-4 5, Boeke 0-0 0-0 0, Kremer 0-0 0-2 0, Quinter 0-1 0-0 0, Gruber 0-0 0-0 0, Spieles 1-1 0-0 3. Totals 13-33 15-26 44.
Mansfield St. Peter's (24-3): Kovinchick 1-8 0-0 3, Riggleman 1-1 1-2 3, Polinski 2-6 0-0 4, Reindl 4-13 0-1 8, Bartlett 2-6 8-8 12, Schmitz 0-0 0-0 0, Krehnovi 0-0 0-0 0, Lindsay 1-6 1-2 3, Andrews 0-0 0-0 0, Finnerty 0-2 0-0 0, Keiser 0-0 0-0 0. Totals 11-42 10-13 33.
3-Point Goals—Minster 3-5 (Brackman 1-1, Slonkosky 1-1, Spieles 1-1, Shenck 0-2), St. Peter's 1-8 (Kovinchick 1-2, Finnerty 0-1, Reindl 0-2, Polinski 0-3). Fouled out—None. Rebounds—Minster 34 (Hoying 9), St. Peter's 25 (Bartlett 5). Assists—Minster 9 (Brackman 3), St. Peter's 8 (Kovinchick 4). Total fouls—Minster 10, St. Peter's 18. A—5,618.

THURSDAY
Boys Basketball
State semifinals
Note: All games at Columbus Value City Arena.
Division III
Loudonville (22-2) vs St. Henry (20-5), 11 a.m.
Bellaire (22-4) vs. Versailles (26-0), 2
Division II
Canal Fulton (24-1) vs. Dayton Chaminade-Julienne (18-7), 6
Ottawa-Glandorf (25-1) vs. Dover (22-3), 9

FRIDAY
Boys Basketball
State semifinals
Note: All games at Columbus Value City Arena.
Division IV
Maria Stein (17-9) vs. Sebring McKinley (24-1), 11 a.m.
South Webster (23-3) vs. Holgate (18-7), 2
Division I
Toledo St. John's (22-4) vs. Cols. Brookhaven (25-2), 6
Canton McKinley (22-3) vs Hamilton (23-2), 9

MARCH 27
State championships
Division II, 11 a.m.
Division III, 2
Division IV, 6
Division I, 9

OUTDOORS

D'ARCY EGAN



State may let boaters power up

Ohio park officials are leaning toward a horsepower hike at sprawling 14,000-acre Pymatuning Reservoir on the Ohio-Pennsylvania border.

Boaters, anglers, area legislators and state park officials will tackle a proposal to increase the horsepower limit from 9.9 horsepower to 20 horsepower at Pymatuning Reservoir at a public hearing on March 31 at 7 p.m. at Pymatuning Valley High School, 5571 State Rt. 6, West Andover, Ohio. The Ohio Division of Parks has been a leader in seeking the horsepower increase.

Dan West, chief of the Ohio Division of Parks, said that raising the horsepower limit is the best choice after receiving comments from lake users. Safety is an issue, according to officials, with larger motors allowing boats to more rapidly seek safe harbor if the weather is bad.

Many local residents and fishermen have complained the horsepower increase will spoil the peaceful nature of the reservoir, as well as increase boat traffic.

Pennsylvania, which owns the majority of Pymatuning Reservoir, has already passed legislation to hike the horsepower limit. The Ohio Legislature, under an agreement with Pennsylvania in 2002, would have to follow suit in order to change limit.

Look out for nets: The Ohio Division of Wildlife is setting nets on Lake Erie's reefs this spring to study the reproductive success of walleye. Fish will be sampled both in the Sandusky and Maumee rivers and on the Lake Erie spawning reefs.

Looking ahead: The Friends of NRA of Lorain County have an annual banquet and auction on April 2 at DeLuca's Place in the Park in Lorain. Call John Szefcyk (440-988-7045) for tickets. . . . John Rochus (330-456-8731) of Ohio Fly Fishing Excursions has six slots open for the annual Spring Steelhead School in the Conneaut area, March 28-30. It offers classroom and on-water instruction for a $400 fee. . . . The deadline for the lottery to fish the trout-filled waters of Cold Creek at the Castalia State Fish hatchery in Erie County is April 1. Call 1-800-WILDLIFE.

Turkey talk at Dick's: The Dick's Sporting Goods stores across the country will host National Wild Turkey Federation Day today. Hunting seminars are planned, according to store official Aimee Kremser, at the Cleveland, Akron and Canton area Dick's Sporting Goods stores.

Gun law rules: The Ashland Gun Club has informational meetings on March 28 from 1-3 p.m. at Gander Mountain in Twinsburg to explain new regulations for concealed carry permits. Seating is limited and reservations are needed. Call 330-405-2999.

Turkey University at Gander: All of the area Gander Mountain stores also will focus on Gander Mountain's Turkey University on Saturday. Hosting turkey hunting seminars and events will be the Gander Mountain stores in Mentor, Twinsburg, Sheffield, Niles-Warren, North Canton, Toledo and Columbus.

Out and about: Brunswick Corp. likes aluminum fishing boats, buying the Crestliner, Lowe and Lund lines of aluminum boats from Genmar Holdings Inc. recently for $191 million. . . . Political pressure last week reversed an Army Corps of Engineers decision not to fund a new electric fence for the Illinois River to prevent Asian carp from slipping into the Great Lakes.

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